10.4.1 Methods of health education

Health education is carried out at 3 main levels;

- Individual Approach.
- Group Approach.
- General Approach/Mass.

Individual Health Education:

Doctors and nurses, who are in direct contact with patients and their relatives, have opportunities for much individual health education. The topic selected should be relevant to the situation. For instance, a mother who has come for delivery should be told about child birth-not about malaria eradication.

The biggest advantage of individual health teaching is that we can discuss, argue and persuade the individual to change his behaviour. The disadvantage is that the numbers we reach are small.

Group Health Education:

The groups are many – mothers, school children, patients, industrial workers – to whom we can direct health teaching. The choice of subject in group health teaching is very important; it must relate directly to the interest of the group. For instance, mothers may be taught about baby care; school children about oral hygiene; a group of TB patients about tuberculosis, and industrial workers about accidents.

10.4.2 Methods of Group Teaching

These have been classified as below:

(i) One – way or didactic methods:

- Lecture
- Films
- Charts
- Flannel graph
- Exhibits
- Flashcards

1. **Lectures:**

   Lectures are the most popular method of health teaching. In this, communication is mostly one-way, i.e., the people are only passive listeners; there is no active participation on their part in learning. How impressive and effective the lecture is, depends upon the personality and reputation of the speaker. A lecture does provide basic information on the subject, but it may fail to change the health behaviour of the people. Nevertheless lectures have an important place in the health education of small groups.

2. **Films, charts & Puppets:**

   These are mass media of communication. They can be of value in educating small groups.

Suspense Charts:

Each section of the charts is covered and is exposed one by one to reveal the story or ideas without exposing the whole chart at a time.

Puppets:

Puppets are dolls made by hand and a story can be narrated using them it is a popular teaching aid to health teaching.

3. **Flannel graph:**

   A flannel graph consists of a wooden board over which is pasted or fixed a

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